

How Design Makes Us Think.



A visual book report by **Emilie Rezendes**

Contents



Seduction

Efficiency

Love

Humor

Elegance

Intelligence

Pride

Innovation

Innocence

Nostalgia

Anger

Pleasure

Honesty

Each chapter was defined by an **emotion**.

Each **emotion** was analyzed through the lense of how typography, color choice, form, material, and imagery can allow a skilled designer to illicit that reaction from a viewer.

Quote



Manipulating a response in the viewer takes both skill and self-awareness.

"...80 percent of the solution will be based on research, logic, and rational thinking. The remaining 20 percent is intuition."

Strengths



This Book Makes You Think.

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This. Book. Makes. You. Think.

Examples

What about a toy makes us **think** of innocence?

A toy is innocent not because children are innocent, but because a toy lacks sophistication, wickedness, knowledge, and guile.

How does a color make us **feel** "happy" or "sad?"

Some colors produce "happy" emotions because of associations we have with them. Learning what color creates what emotion in what audience is key.

Why do emotional dog commercials make us **want** to donate?

They play on our ingrained memories from movies (think *A Dog's Purpose*), books (*Old Yeller*), or past experiences (we have all loved a dog...right?).

Also, why does the Apple logo have a bite out of it?

How the heck should I know? I'm not Einstein, bro.

Weaknesses



Picture placement.

Often the images being referenced in the text appear on a different page, meaning the reader has to flip between pages to fully understand the impact of the author's words.

First chapter is the best chapter.

What the rest of the book takes a YouTube video to reiterate, the introduction provides in TikTok form.

Content.

Some of the content is not suitable for kids, and therefore, me.

Questions.

The book never answered the question as to why the Apple logo has a bite out of it. I was sorely disappointed.

Recommendations



I would recommend this book to anyone who would like either a basic overview or an in-depth analysis of the psychology of design, from the viewpoint of a designer. The author has created this book to be useful to both newbies and hardened pros, making it a versatile and useful purchase (or borrow, if you are a poor college student).

However, be warned. If you delve into this book, you may never see cereal boxes, flower vases, coffee tables or toilets the same way...ever again.

